

Syllabus

Instructor Details

Course Information

Course Number: VIST 409
Course Title: Capstone Studio

Section: 502
Time: Tue/Thurs 8:00 to 10:30am
Location: ARCC 306 A
Credit Hours: 3 (1:5)

Instructor Details

Instructor: Michael Bruner, Assistant Instructional Professor
Phone: 214.463.4127
E-Mail: michaelbruner@tamu.edu
Office: <https://tamu.zoom.us/j/2348119390>
Office Hours: Wednesday, 10:00 – 11:30 am, or by appointment.

Course Description

The capstone studio allows the student to create a culminating project that emphasizes an innovative and comprehensive solution for a complex problem in Visualization, and to learn about appropriate publication and exhibition venues. The proposition, scope, and level of complexity of the project is prepared in advance during VIST 339 and VIST 439, Capstone Studio Proposal, which includes a detailed outline of the goal and completion schedule.

Course Prerequisites

VIST 405 and VIST 439

Special Course Designation

None

Learning Management Platforms & Classroom Tools

CANVAS will be used as the Learning Management Platform

Google Drive:
2:20 PM - [Turn in Folder](#)

Course Communication

The only official and formal ways to receive information about this course are in class, through **TAMU email**, through the CANVAS learning management system - please note emails sent through canvas will be checked weekly. *Grades will be made available only through Canvas and will only be discussed in one-on-one meetings or through one-on-one TAMU email.*

For informal discussions and support, discord will be set up specifically for this course and enrolled students will receive an invitation to join. Students are under no obligation to do so.

The instructor and Teaching Assistant will respond to email as promptly as possible 8 am-5 pm CST Monday through Friday and when possible outside of those days and times.

Course Learning Outcomes

At the conclusion of this course, students should be able to:

1. Develop a clear concept for the aesthetic, historical, and contemporary context for execution of their capstone project based on **literary research**.
2. **Analyze and defend** the process and results of the research required to support the capstone project.
3. Collaborate in the **critique** of individual capstone projects
4. **Synthesize knowledge** accumulated throughout the undergraduate program.
5. Formulate and keep scheduled deadlines as an integral part of the design process.
6. Demonstrate the ability to communicate orally, in written form, and visually through the production of the capstone project.

Textbook and/or Resource Materials

No Textbook is required for this course.

Costs may be incurred by the student to support the creation of the capstone project and at the responsibility of the student (costs will vary by project). There are grants and opportunities available for reimbursement:

GRANTS

There are funds available for the department. Please refer to the PVFA Scholarship Information and Application link.

Grading Policy

This is a project-oriented course with a focus on the expression of artistic skill and insight, deep understanding of the field, technical proficiency, and the capacity to present ideas and respond to feedback. Projects are assessed based upon digital files turned-in by the student along with presentation of ideas and participation in discussion. The final project should represent a combination of the interests, skills and knowledge gained during your time in the BS-Visualization program and based on research and understanding of the subject matter.

Assessment will be a combination of the Project, Check In's and Iterative Renders. Please see the project description sheet for details.

Process / Weekly Check In:

To facilitate and aid in successful completion and presentation of the final project several activities are expected and assessed during the semester. These should include reference images, progress images, mentor feedback and next week's objectives.

7 points total/1 point per class *** these CAN NOT be made up! Even if the ppt is turned in on the drive. This is about being present and getting critique**

*one-on-one check ins may be called depending on progress.

Check-In	Absent or No update	Limited Progress. May or may not include some of the following: images, engaging/informative content. Previous Feedback was not applied.	Medium Progress. May or may not include some of the following: images, engaging/informative content.	Thorough description and images of progress/research or issues. Engaging and informative. Substantial Progress.
Points for Check-In	0	.25	.50	1

Attendance:

Showing up to class and participating in class discussions is important.

The final grade for the semester will be determined by the student's capacity to be present during class meeting times and engagement with the other members of the class and the instructor when discussing and reviewing course materials and other the work of other students.

Missing more than 3 classes will result in a zero for Attendance.

Includes active Critique - See rubric below.

Critique	No questions asked	1-2 questions asked that are not insightful addresses both feedback and how changes may be implemented based on class critique	Insightful observations and questions asked addresses both feedback and how changes may be implemented based on class critique
Points for Critique	0	0.5	1
Technology Use	On Phone/ Laptop	Checks Phone/Laptop Partially engaged	Technology Free Fully engaged
Points for Feedback	0	0.5	1
Attendance at project critique session	not present	present	
Points for Attendance	0	0.5	

Milestone Presentations:

Milestones are broken down into these 3 stages: 50% | 80% | Final Presentation

Each is worth 5 points, for a total of 15 points.

These are milestone check-ins that focus on **research** and updates to your project, as well as your **presentation skills**.

Format Should Follow The Presentation Template and Showcase achievement and
Considered A Practice Public Speech.

Body Language & Tone Will Be Judged.

These can not be made up if unexcused absence.

Check-In	Absent or No update	Lacked engaging/informative content. unclear communication and understanding of applied research.	Medium Progress. May or may not include some of the following: good body language, clear understanding of research. Unclear product.	engaging/informative content. Engaging and interesting communication and understanding of applied research.
Points for MILE STONE	0	2.5	4	5

Blog Creation:

Create a Blog of progress that includes successes, iterations, issues etc. Include images and content. 10 weekly postings excluding Spring Break. Weeks 2-13

EXAMPLES

1. <https://natalyaabrahamian.myportfolio.com/undergraduate-capstone>
2. <https://casonquisenberry.myportfolio.com/escape-the-arcade-vr>

Blog Updates / Postings	No on-time update	Posted Progress. May or may not include some of the following: images, engaging/informative content	Through Written description and images of progress/research or issues. Engaging and informative.
Points for Blog - per week	0	0.5	1

Project: The contributions of all assessed activities for this course relative to the composition of the final grade is:

Project		Limited Progress towards deliverables. And/Or lacking final renders, progress or level of quality.	Medium Progress towards deliverables. Some mastery displayed.	Challenging and Impactful contribution to Research and Technical achievement.
Points		10	15	20

Paper:

Paper		Clear and thorough coverage of literary research and comparable artists as well as a clear explanation of your understanding of how your	Decent literary research and comparable artists and/or an unclear explanation of your understanding of	literary research, comparable artists lacking in substance and/or an unclear explanation of your understanding of how

		work contributes to this conversation.	how your work contributes to this conversation.	your work contributes to this conversation.
Points		10	8	6

Documentation AND Tutorial Video Rubric:

Video		Shows Unclear Research/Comprehension and application of concepts within a visualized manner. Acceptable Process, Breakdown and explanation.	Shows Research/Comprehension and application of concepts within a visualized manner. Acceptable Process, Breakdown and explanation.	Shows Research/Comprehension and application of concepts within a visualized manner. Clear Process, Breakdown and explanation.
Points for Video		5	8	10

Proposal | Rubber Duck | GANTT: Students will present an idea with a breakdown of timeline and process to achieve the deadline within a timeline.

Mentorship: Students will find an external and internal mentor for weekly/bi-weekly guidance outside of classroom critique.

Extra Credit: Opportunities to earn extra credit may be offered during the semester. Each opportunity will be available to all students and will involve an activity, task, or participation that is related to the subject matter of this course. Students will select **one** of the following to earn 5 points.

- Outside class engagement
 - >Send instructor name and confirmation email from them that you completed the activity
 - >Guest Lecture / Demo for a class
 - Freshman Seminar
 - Vertical Studio
 - Etc.

>Guest Critique for a class

- Needs 2 sessions with instructor confirmation of attendance

- Research Symposium Participation

>Have to be accepted and present your work

- Research Focused (Explainer) Poster Creation - Submitted to VIZ Show / SIGGRAPH

Grading Policy * Please see above for rubric

Due Over the course of the semester * Can not be made up

Proposal Rubber Ducky GANTT	3 points
Weekly Check In* - Powerpoint	7 points
Milestone Presentations* (60/80/Final 5 pts each)	20 points
Attendance	15 points
Blog (10 entries)	10 points
Mentorship	5 points

Due at END of Course

Project	20 points
Documentation OR Tutorial Video	10 points
Paper	10 points
Total Points:	100 points

Grading Formula

As an aid to understanding your grade, read the following. It will help you understand your performance as it relates to your final semester grade.

Grade	
A 90+	An "A" student demonstrates mastery of the various course learning objectives, turns in all assignments on time, participates to the fullest in class and group projects, and misses no more than one class meeting
B 80-89	A "B" student masters the majority of course learning objectives, turns in all assignments on time, participates in class discussions and group assignments, and misses no more than two class meetings.
C 70-79	A "C" student masters about half the course learning outcomes, turns in most assignments on time, participates in class when called on, contributes minimally to group assignments, and misses no more than two class meetings.
D 60-69	A "D" student performs unsatisfactorily, fails to turn in all assignments, and misses no more than three class meetings.
F <60	An "F" will be earned by any student who fails to turn in more than half the assignments and misses more than three class meetings.

Late Work Policy

No late work will be accepted unless accompanied by a doctor's note.

Course Schedule

Schedule may be adjusted and students will be notified.

DATE	CLASS #	LECTURE TOPICS
Tuesday, August 20, 2024	1	Syllabus Project Presentation Expectations Blog Creation Notion GANTT
Thursday, August 22, 2024	2	Pitch Presentations GANTT
Tuesday, August 27, 2024	3	Career Aspirations / Industry mentors
Thursday, August 29, 2024	4	Workdays
Tuesday, September 03, 2024	5	Check In - Group A
Thursday, September 05, 2024	6	Check In - Group B
Tuesday, September 10, 2024	7	Check In - Group A
Thursday, September 12, 2024	8	Check In - Group B
Tuesday, September 17, 2024	9	MILESTONE 1 Presentations A
Thursday, September 19, 2024	10	MILESTONE 1 Presentations B
Tuesday, September 24, 2024	11	Check In - Group A
Thursday, September 26, 2024	12	Check In - Group B
Tuesday, October 01, 2024	13	Check In - Group A
Thursday, October 03, 2024	14	Check In - Group B
Tuesday, October 08, 2024	FALL BREAK	
Thursday, October 10, 2024	15	Guest Speaker (Recent Grad)
Tuesday, October 15, 2024	16	Check In - Group A
Thursday, October 17, 2024	17	Check In - Group B
Tuesday, October 22, 2024	18	Check In - Group A
Thursday, October 24, 2024	19	Check In - Group B
Tuesday, October 29, 2024	20	MILESTONE 2 Presentations A

Thursday, October 31, 2024	21	MILESTONE 2 Presentations B
Tuesday, November 05, 2024	22	Check In - Group A
Thursday, November 07, 2024	23	Check In - Group B
Tuesday, November 12, 2024	24	Guest Speaker (Industry Recruiter)
Thursday, November 14, 2024	25	Workdays
Tuesday, November 19, 2024	26	MILESTONE Presentations Final Project
Thursday, November 21, 2024	27	MILESTONE Presentations Final Project
Tuesday, November 26, 2024	28	Final Deliverables Course Evaluation
Thursday, November 28, 2024	THANKSGIVING	

Optional Course Information Items

Learning Resources –

TAMU writing Center

<https://writingcenter.tamu.edu>

University Policies

This section outlines the university level policies that must be included in each course syllabus. The TAMU Faculty Senate established the wording of these policies.

Attendance Policy

The university views class attendance and participation as an individual student responsibility. Students are expected to attend class and to complete all assignments.

Please refer to [Student Rule 7](#) in its entirety for information about excused absences, including definitions, and related documentation and timelines.

Makeup Work Policy

Students will be excused from attending class on the day of a graded activity or when attendance contributes to a student's grade, for the reasons stated in Student Rule 7, or other reason deemed appropriate by the instructor.

Please refer to [Student Rule 7](#) in its entirety for information about makeup work, including definitions, and related documentation and timelines.

Absences related to Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972 may necessitate a period of more than 30 days for make-up work, and the timeframe for make-up work should be agreed upon by the student and instructor” ([Student Rule 7, Section 7.4.1](#)).

“The instructor is under no obligation to provide an opportunity for the student to make up work missed because of an unexcused absence” ([Student Rule 7, Section 7.4.2](#)).

Students who request an excused absence are expected to uphold the Aggie Honor Code and Student Conduct Code. (See [Student Rule 24](#).)

Academic Integrity Statement and Policy

“An Aggie does not lie, cheat or steal, or tolerate those who do.”

“Texas A&M University students are responsible for authenticating all work submitted to an instructor. If asked, students must be able to produce proof that the item submitted is indeed the work of that student. Students must keep appropriate records at all times. The inability to authenticate one’s work, should the instructor request it, may be sufficient grounds to initiate an academic misconduct case” ([Section 20.1.2.3, Student Rule 20](#)).

You can learn more about the Aggie Honor System Office Rules and Procedures, academic integrity, and your rights and responsibilities at aggiehonor.tamu.edu.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) Policy

Texas A&M University is committed to providing equitable access to learning opportunities for all students. If you experience barriers to your education due to a disability or think you may have a disability, please contact Disability Resources in the Student Services Building or at (979) 845-1637 or visit disability.tamu.edu. Disabilities may include, but are not limited to attentional, learning, mental health, sensory, physical, or chronic health conditions. All students are encouraged to discuss their disability related needs with Disability Resources and their instructors as soon as possible.

Title IX and Statement on Limits to Confidentiality

Texas A&M University is committed to fostering a learning environment that is safe and productive for all. University policies and federal and state laws prohibit gender-based discrimination and sexual harassment, including sexual assault, sexual exploitation, domestic violence, dating violence, and stalking.

With the exception of some medical and mental health providers, all university employees (including full and part-time faculty, staff, paid graduate assistants, student workers, etc.) are

Mandatory Reporters must report to the Title IX Office if the employee experiences, observes, or becomes aware of an incident that meets the following conditions (see [University Rule 08.01.01.M1](#)):

- The incident is reasonably believed to be discrimination or harassment.
- The incident is alleged to have been committed by or against a person who, at the time of the incident, was (1) a student enrolled at the University or (2) an employee of the University.

Mandatory Reporters must file a report regardless of how the information comes to their attention – including but not limited to face-to-face conversations, a written class assignment or paper, class discussion, email, text, or social media post. Although Mandatory Reporters must file a report, in most instances, you will be able to control how the report is handled, including whether or not to pursue a formal investigation. The University's goal is to make sure you are aware of the range of options available to you and to ensure access to the resources you need.

Students wishing to discuss concerns in a confidential setting are encouraged to make an appointment with [Counseling and Psychological Services](#) (CAPS).

Students can learn more about filing a report, accessing supportive resources, and navigating the Title IX investigation and resolution process on the University's [Title IX webpage](#).

Statement on Mental Health and Wellness

Students who need to talk with someone confidentially about any situation can contact (CAPS). [Counseling and Psychological Services](#) (CAPS).

Personal Illness

Students experiencing personal injury or illness that is too severe for the student to attend class qualify for an excused absence (See [Student Rule 7, Section 7.2.2.](#)) To receive an excused absence, students must comply with the documentation and notification guidelines outlined in Student Rule 7.

AI in the classroom

There may be situations and contexts within this course where you will be asked to use A.I. tools to explore how they can be used. Outside of those circumstances, A.I. tools is not allowed to generate content (text, video, audio, images) that will end up in any work (assignments, activities, responses, etc) that is part of your evaluation in this course. Any student work submitted using A.I. tools should clearly indicate what work is the student's work and what part is generated by the A.I.. When A.I. is being used for class projects and/or assignments, students MUST cite which A.I. application they used, and describe how it was used in their assignment. In such cases, no more than 25% of the student work should be generated by A.I. If any part of this is confusing or uncertain, please reach out to your instructor for a conversation before submitting your work.

Writing Center

The University Writing Center (UWC) has trained peer consultants available to work with you on any kind of writing or speaking project, including research papers, lab reports, application essays, or creative writing, and at any stage of your process, whether you're deciding on a topic or reviewing your final draft. You can also get help with public speaking, presentations, and group projects. We can work with you in person at our Evans or BLCC locations or via Zoom or email. To schedule an appointment or to view our handouts, videos, or interactive learning modules, visit writingcenter.tamu.edu. If you have questions, need help making an appointment, or encounter difficulty accessing our services, call 979-458-1455 or email uwc@tamu.edu.